

Awards

Digi-Key receives distributor of the year award

Electronic components distributor Digi-Key has received *Distributor of the Year Award* from Vishay Intertechnology, one of Digi-Key's authorised supplier partners.

Digi-Key too presented Vishay with a *Superior Sales Performance Award*, in recognition of Vishay's excellent track record of supplying its components to Digi-Key and supporting Digi-Key's successful strategy of business growth and development.

The awards were presented at *Electronic Distribution Show & Conference (EDS)*, held recently in Las Vegas, Nevada.

Fujitsu, Toshiba to merge mobile operations

Fujitsu and Toshiba have agreed to merge their mobile phone businesses. As part of the deal, Toshiba will transfer its mobile phone business to a new company that will be established by October 2010. Fujitsu will hold a majority stake (70-80 per cent) in the joint venture.

By merging their mobile phones businesses, Fujitsu and Toshiba are aiming to become the No. 1 provider of mobile phones in Japan. Collaboration in the mobile phone business will allow Fujitsu and Toshiba to strengthen their handset development platforms for the Japanese market.

Tablets to outsell netbooks in the US

In the US, starting in 2012, tablets will outsell netbooks, and by 2014, more consumers will use tablets than netbooks, says a Forrester Research report. According to the report, fuelled by a growing interest in tablet computers, nearly half a billion PCs will be sold to consumers in the US between now and 2015.

Over the next five years, PC unit sales across all form factors—desktops, notebooks and laptops, tablets, and netbooks—will increase by 52 per cent. Data in the report is based on Forrester's five-year forecast for the personal computing and eReader markets in the US.

Despite an ongoing industry debate about how to define tablets, Forrester believes these should be classified as a form of personal computer. Tablet sales in the US will go from a modest 3.5 million units in 2010 to 20.4 million units in 2015—a 42 per cent compound annual growth rate. In 2015, tablets will constitute 23 per cent of PC unit sales.

"Tablet growth will come at the expense of netbooks, which have a similar grab-and-go media consumption and Web browsing use case as tablets but don't synchronise data across services like the iPad does," said Sarah Rotman Epps, analyst, Forrester Research.

Kingston to double investment

Kingston Technology Corporation, the global manufacturer of memory modules and digital media products, is planning to double its investment in India to cater to the increasing demand for memory products. The company is also mulling a manufacturing plant in India by 2012-13.

"We are positioned as the leading independent memory module manufacturer with an expected growth of 10-15 per cent in India. Our modest growth is attributed to a rise in the average selling price, healthier demand from corporate-end customers and individuals," said Vishal Parekh, marketing manager, APAC business division, Kingston.

The company is also looking at expanding its reach to new areas like gaming and servers.

EFYTimes goes 'social'

EFYTimes.com is leveraging social networking platforms like Facebook and Twitter to have the readers share their feedback on its content, voice opinions and tell how it can serve them better through its content. The aim is to have the EFYTimes.com readers community share their feedback in a more dynamic and interactive manner.

Readers too can keep it posted on the latest happenings in technology from across the globe, by sending it prompts, tweets and posting links on the Facebook page.

So it is more of an invite to all of those who have a nose for the news, and who would like to be citizen journalists for EFYTimes.com.

Agilent curriculum-based engineering solutions

Agilent Technologies has introduced four curriculum-based university-level teaching solutions developed to save educators' time and help get the most out of their equipment. The new solutions cover programming, RF design and telecommunications. Agilent already offers solutions in basic electronics, RF circuit design, digital systems, analogue electronics, digital signal processing and digital RF communications.

Each teaching solution comprises carefully designed undergraduate engineering coursework that has an ideal mix of teaching slide sets, problem-based student labs and industry-standard measurement equipment.

RS announces new ST components

RS Components, distributor of electronic, electromechanical and industrial products, has introduced over 750 additional semiconductor lines from STMicroelectronics. The enhanced product portfolio offers electronic design engineers a wide selection of the latest semiconductor technology available for rapid delivery from RS.

The product range incorporates ten technology areas ranging from linear regulators, controllers, RTC ICs and over 50 lines of new SuperMESH high-voltage power MOSFETs (up to 1000V with integrated zener diode). It also incorporates STripFet low-voltage MOSFET technology featuring low RDS (on) in DC-DC conversion.

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